PRANA · SETUP GUIDE

PRANA
Voice Notes

Talk to PRANA, hear it talk back. Send a Telegram voice note — Whisper transcribes it, the brain thinks, and the reply arrives as playable audio.

~3 min	on by default	OpenAI key
total setup	in prana-telegram	required

🤖 AUTOMATIC — PRANA / installer does it 👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP — needs a human (account / browser)

> ℹ️ **HONEST SCOPE**
>
> This is **voice notes** — not phone calls. Real phone calls need Twilio (paid account), which is out of scope for v1. Everything here uses **your existing OpenAI key**: no new accounts, no new vendors.

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What you're building

After this guide: hold the mic button in your PRANA Telegram chat, speak, and get a **spoken reply back** — playable audio, not just text. The agent hears you via Whisper, thinks with its full brain, and answers with an OpenAI voice.

How the voice pipeline works



> 🔒 **PRIVACY NOTE**
>
> The downloaded audio is **deleted immediately after transcription** — never kept on disk. Your voice never sits in a folder somewhere.

1 Get Telegram working first

🤖 AUTOMATIC

Voice rides on the Telegram channel. If you haven't done it yet, follow the **PRANA Telegram Setup Guide** (Guide 3 of 5) — bot token, `prana-telegram`, `/start` working.

2 Save an OpenAI key

👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP

Voice needs OpenAI specifically — Whisper for hearing, TTS for speaking. (Your chat brain can still be any provider.)

PowerShell

```
$ prana --save-key
Paste API key (hidden): ••••••••••••
# paste an OpenAI key (starts with sk-) — auto-detected as "openai"
```

Get one at **platform.openai.com → API keys**. PRANA looks for the OpenAI key in this order: `--key` flag → `OPENAI_API_KEY` env → saved config.

3 Start Telegram — voice is already on

🤖 AUTOMATIC

Voice is **enabled by default** — no extra flag needed:

PowerShell

```
$ prana-telegram
🤖 connected as @my_prana_bot (PRANA) — polling
# if no OpenAI key is found you'll see:
voice: no OpenAI key — voice notes will transcribe/reply as text
(run `prana --save-key` with an OpenAI key for full voice)
```

To disable voice entirely: `prana-telegram --no-voice`

✓ Verify it works

✅ In your PRANA Telegram chat, **hold the mic button** and say: *"summarize what you can do"*

✅ PRANA transcribes it, thinks, and replies with a **playable voice note** 🔊

✅ Try a follow-up by voice — conversation history carries across voice and text

Troubleshooting

Error / symptom	Fix
`🎙️ "I couldn't transcribe that voice note — voice needs an OpenAI API key…"`	No OpenAI key configured. Run `prana --save-key` and paste an `sk-` key.
`voice: no OpenAI key — voice notes will transcribe/reply as text`	Startup warning (not fatal). Voice degrades gracefully to text until an OpenAI key is saved.
`Voice note transcribed but reply came as text`	TTS step failed (check terminal for `voice reply failed, falling back to text`). Usually a key/quota issue — text fallback is by design.
`"transcription came back empty — try a clearer voice note"`	Whisper got silence or noise. Re-record closer to the mic.
`Long replies get cut in audio`	TTS caps input at 4000 chars — long answers are clipped for speech. Ask for a summary for full voice replies.

Quick reference

Item	Value
Enable (default)	`prana-telegram` — voice on
Disable	`prana-telegram --no-voice`
Transcription	OpenAI Whisper `whisper-1`
Speech	OpenAI TTS `tts-1`, voice `alloy`, mp3
Key needed	OpenAI `sk-` key via `prana --save-key`
TTS cap	4000 chars per reply
Audio retention	Deleted immediately after transcription